

Poppy

Poppies can turn whole fields red. Their bright, papery petals are a common sight in meadows. Not all poppies are red though. Some are yellow, blue, orange, purple, or white. The pocket-sized Arctic poppy is one of the few plants that can grow in the far north. Its butter yellow flowers are a small splash of colour in the icy Arctic.

Once poppies have flowered, they dry into fragile balls, which rattle with all the seeds inside. On windy days, the seeds fly out, spreading over the ground. They will wait until conditions are right to grow. The seeds are often brought to the soil's surface by digging, which is why poppies often pop up on building sites and beside new roads.



Breadseed poppy,
Southern Europe



Welsh poppy,
Western Europe



Arctic poppy,
The Arctic

